

EVIDENCE · CANVAS · SERIES

word-cloud

Spiral-packed word cloud — items sized by weight.

What 38 win/loss interviews kept saying, by frequency.



What this branch named, by weight.



A word cloud constellation diagram with the word 'component' at the center in large blue font. Other words are arranged around it: 'function' (gold) is above and to the left; 'gallery' (grey) is above and to the right; 'form' (gold) is to the right; 'manifest' (blue) is below and to the right; 'substance' (grey) is below and to the left.

function gallery
component form
substance manifest

Every term this branch touched.



What this branch named, by weight.



The one word that defined the branch.



Stress test — 20 terms, raw frequency counts (512 → 5).



What 38 win/loss interviews kept saying, by frequency.



What 38 win/loss interviews kept saying, by frequency.



What 38 win/loss interviews kept saying, by frequency.



When NOT to reach for word-cloud.

Precise comparisons. If the audience needs to know that 'manifest' is 1.6× 'function', the spiral packing actively misleads. Use `progress` or a bar chart where the eye can compare lengths directly.

Two or three words. A three-word cloud is a list with extra steps. Use `stats` for a metric row or `big-number` for a single weighted headline.

Multi-word phrases. Each li should be a single token. Multi-word phrases blow out the layout and crowd the spiral; if your data is phrases, normalise to keywords first or use `quote` for verbatim text.

See also.

RELATED COMPONENTS

`progress` — the weights need precise visual comparison

`stats` — the headline metrics are independent numbers, not a corpus

`piechart` — the items are parts of a whole, not free-form themes

`quote` — the verbatim language matters more than the frequency

`tldr` — the qualitative summary is prose, not a packed cloud